Jenny DEVAUD

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Do you have a favorite teacher that made an impact on your life, and how? (Limit to 100 words)

Dr. DeRoche was our band teacher and I admired him a great deal. He somehow had a cool dude affect to him that I really liked, and I seem to remember that he invited us at times to his home.

What was your favorite hang-out place in High School?

I don;t think I really spent much time there...so I can't really remember.

What were your top 3 favorite songs in High School? Add the artist, if known.

No recollection!

What is your fondest memory of Willowbrook High School?(Limit to 100 words)

One of my only memories is of my reluctance to take physics because I had a perfect grade point average and didn't want to wreck it. My chemistry teacher told me that any girl that took physics would get an A, which I knew was false, but recognized that he wanted me to continue in science so I took it (and aced it). I do also remember a friendly academic competitiveness with....was it Jon Stiffler?

Give us a brief history of your life since graduating: (Limit to 300 words)

I left Willowbrook after Junior Year, instead attending Elmhurst College for my last year. I had hoped to attend college in Switzerland as a Swiss citizen but ended up only spending 5 months there before returning to the US, and waiting for the next academic year to attend MIT for undergraduate, working a year and a half and finishing my doctorate at Harvard University, followed by a postdoctoral fellowship. My son was 5 months old when I defended my thesis, and my daughter was born 2 years later. My husband and I moved to Boulder, CO, where I have lived ever since. I divorced twice and am now married to my third, and final, husband ;)

Tell us about your career path: (Limit to 100 words)

I worked as a researcher after my postdoc in nanometer lithography at U. of Colorado, then about a ecade in the magnetic storage business. The last 22 years of my career I worked at Ball Aerospace on a wide variety of space telescopes, including the James Webb Space Telescope. I did experimental and modeling work having to do with molecular transport, fluid mechanics and the effect of the space environment on telescopes.